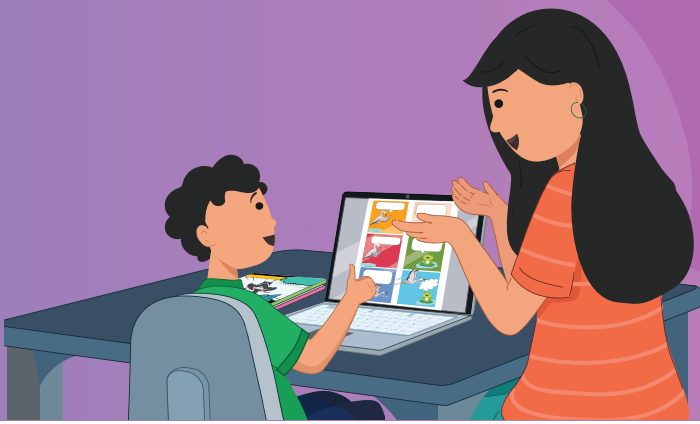




Hey Sid, what are you reading?

Yes, it's fun to read them.

How nice! You can do that now as well. Come, let's see how.

I am reading a comic book.  
I love them!

I want to write comic books when I grow up!



Look at your textbook and list out all the elements you see. What are they? Do they make you want to read the stories and poems in it?

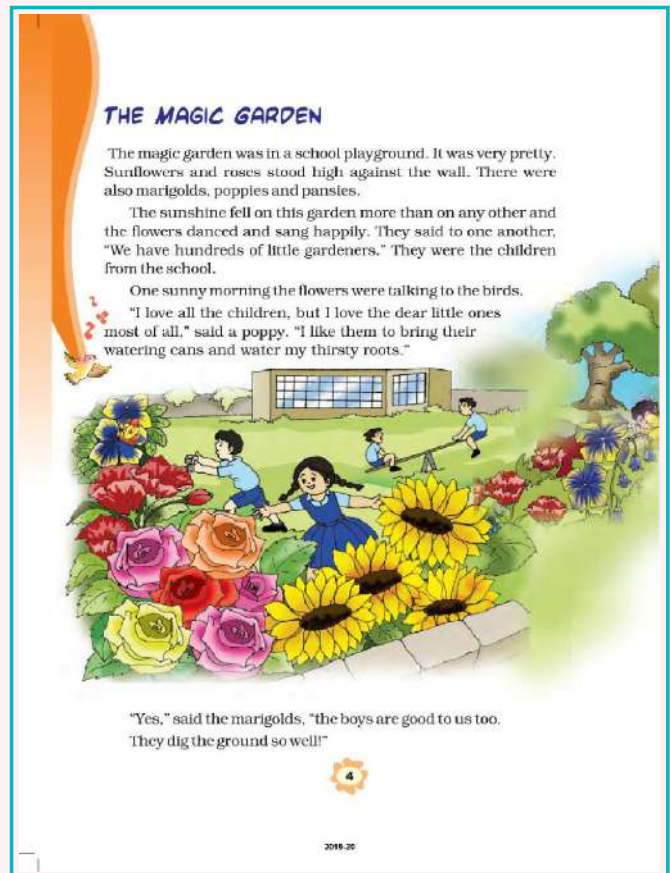


Image credits: NCERT

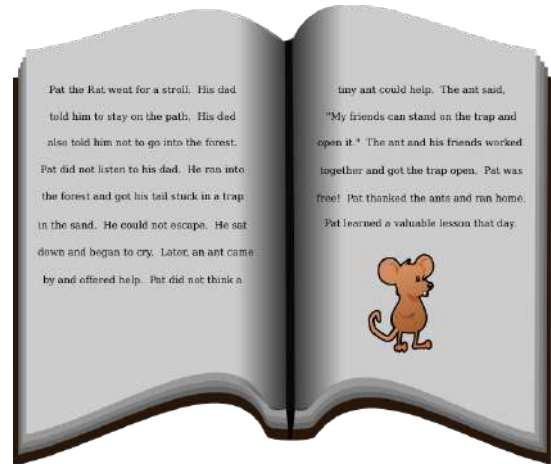
In a textbook, stories and poems are presented with pictures of characters and dialogues. This makes the text easy to read and grabs the reader's attention. The other elements of a textbook include headings, page numbers, and the author's name.

Apart from textbooks, there are lots of different types of books.

## Storybooks

Storybooks contain a story or a collection of stories, and are usually meant for children. The stories can have one or more characters. The main character in a storybook is called the **lead**.

For example:



Story Book

## Comic Books

A comic book is a collection of individual scenes known as comic strips. Each comic strip contains characters, images, and dialogues to tell a story. They tell the story of one lead over the course of many books. These books are called periodicals.

For example:



## Parts of a Comic Book

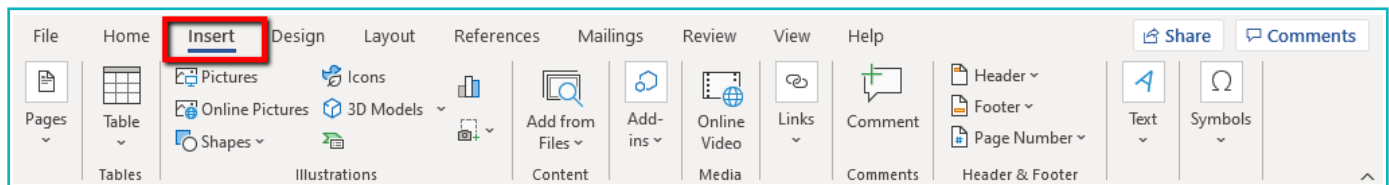
There are 3 main parts of a comic book: characters, dialogues and background as shown in the picture.

- **Characters:** A character is a part of the story which is told through images. A comic book can have multiple characters. Each character will have different dialogues. A character can be a person, animal or thing.
- **Dialogue:** A dialogue is the conversation between two or more characters.
- **Background:** A background is added to make the comic strip colourful or to add scenes related to the dialogue.

We can create comics in MS Word. We use the Insert tab in MS Word to add pictures, text, and background.

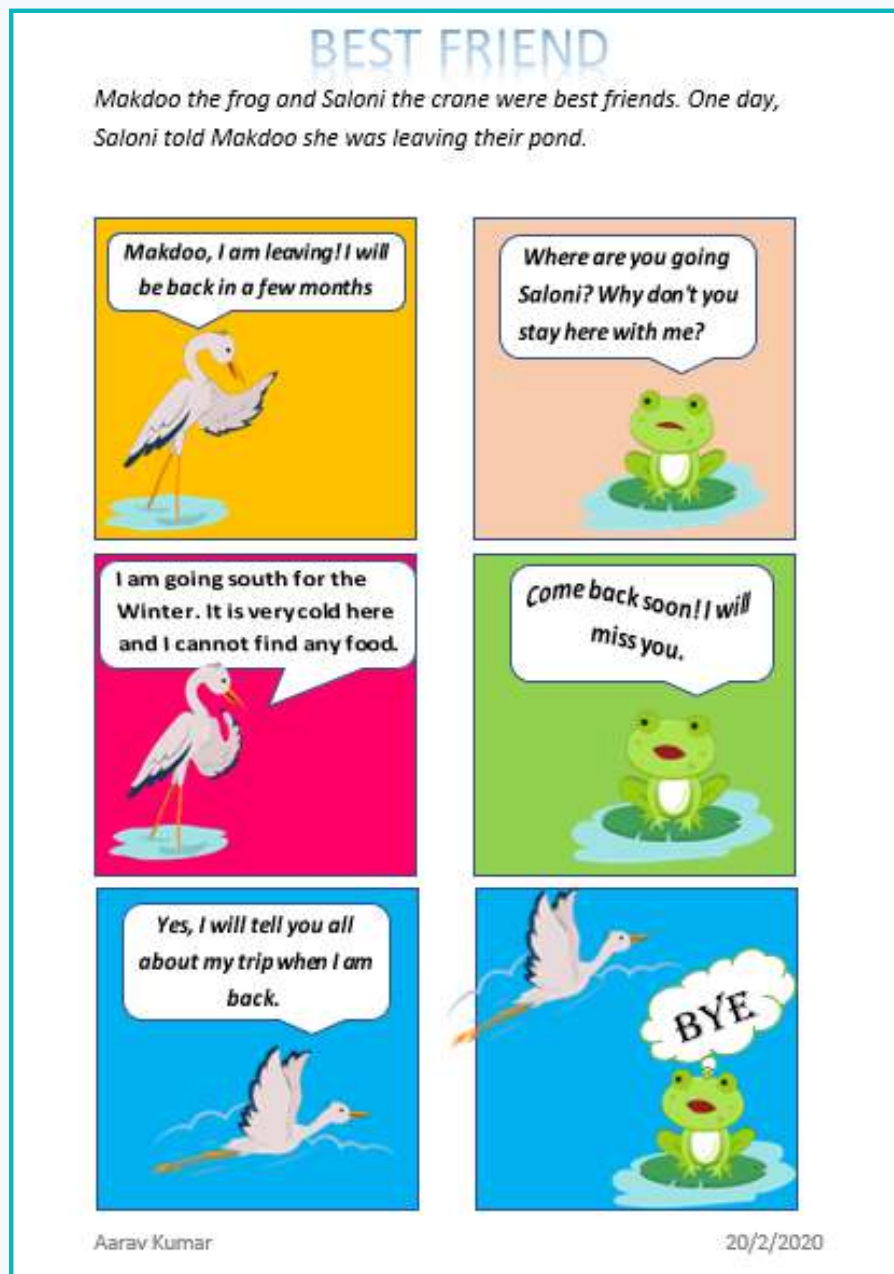
## Insert Tab

The insert tab allows us to add tables, pictures, clip art, shapes, charts, and page numbers to a Word document. We also use it to add WordArt, headers, and footers. The insert tab is located at the top left corner of a Word document.



## Activity

Use the Insert tab to create the comic strip given below.



Best Friend

## Activity

Makdoo the frog and Saloni the crane were best friends. One day, Saloni told Makdoo she was leaving their pond.

**Saloni:** Makdoo, I am leaving! I will be back in a few months.

**Makdoo:** Where are you going Saloni? Why don't you stay here with me?

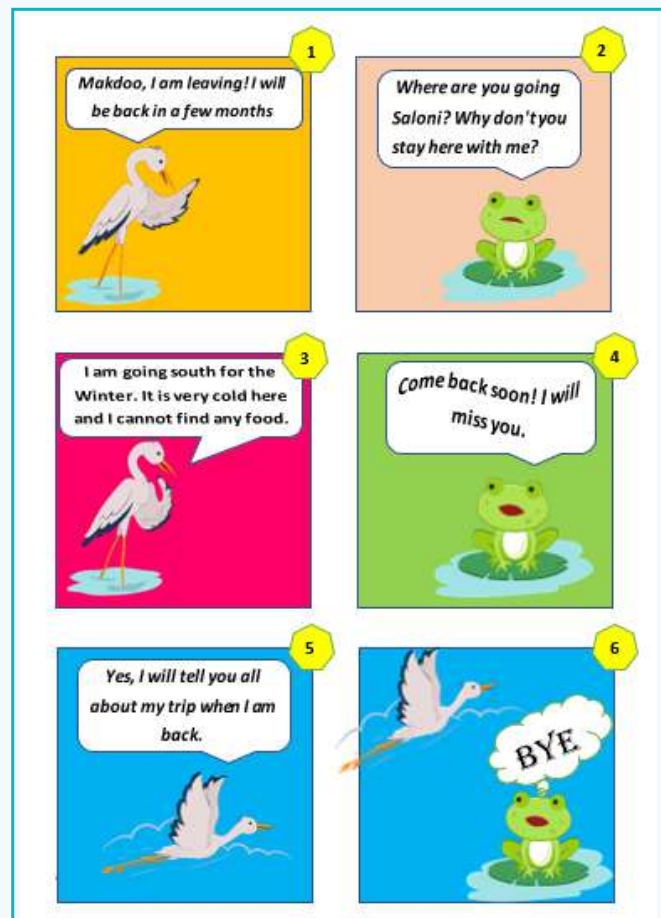
**Saloni:** I am going south for the Winter. It is very cold here and I cannot find any food.

**Makdoo:** Come back soon! I will miss you.

**Saloni:** Yes, I will tell you all about my trip when I am back.

**Makdoo:** Bye

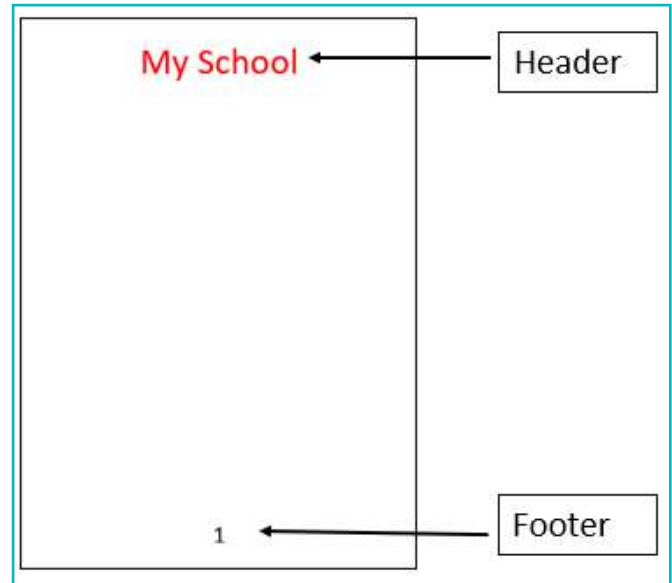
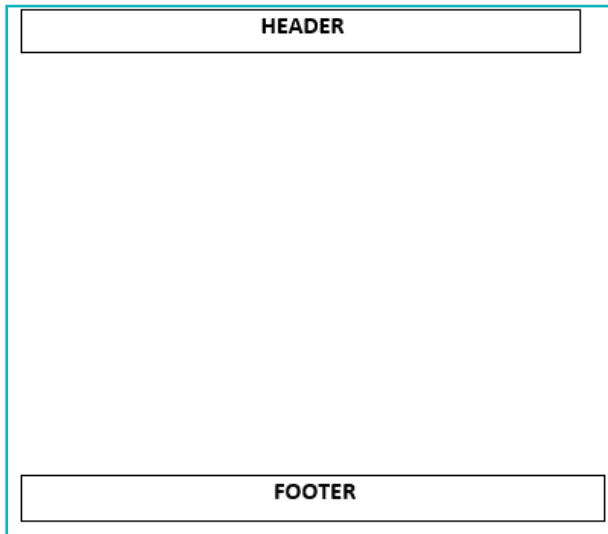
The sequence of the dialogues will be as follows:



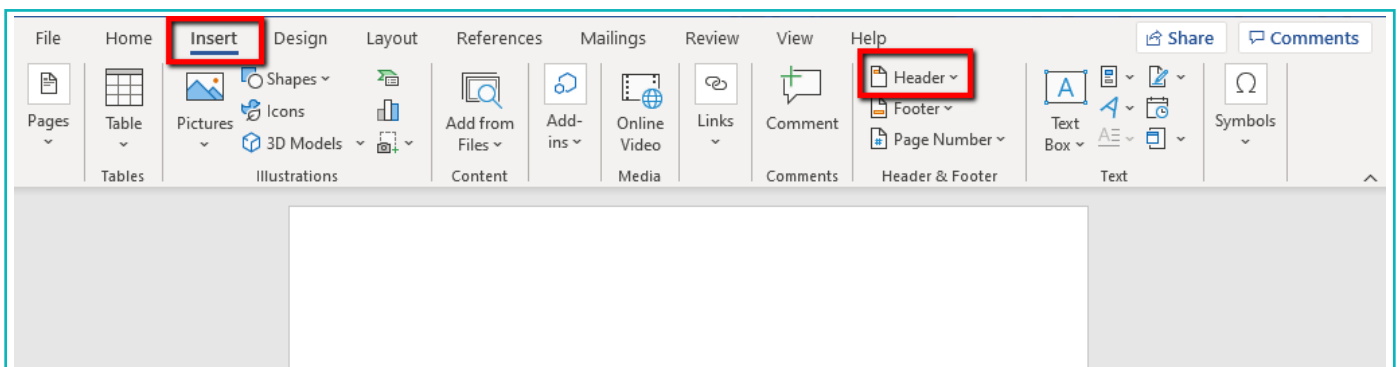


## Let's create our comic strip

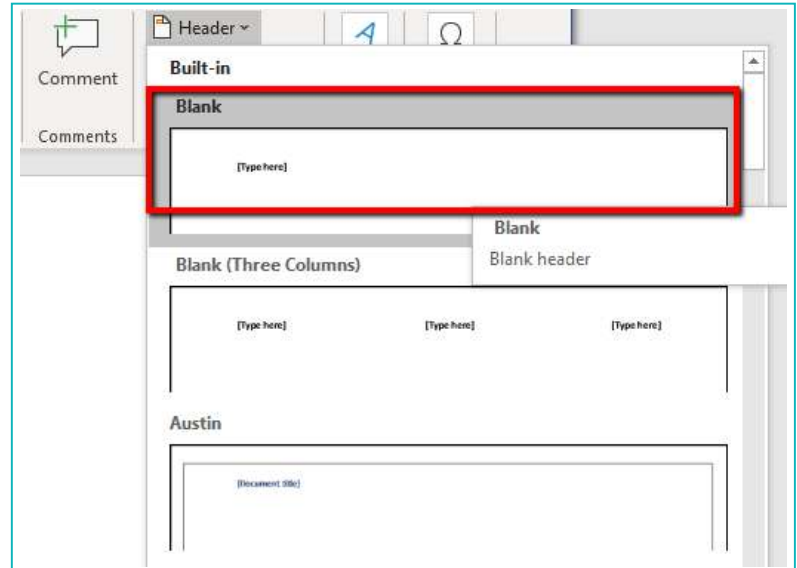
A header is the top section (margin) of a document and a footer is the bottom section. The **header** and **footer** are used to mention the date, time, page number, and headings. They are especially used for the information that we want to repeat on multiple pages.



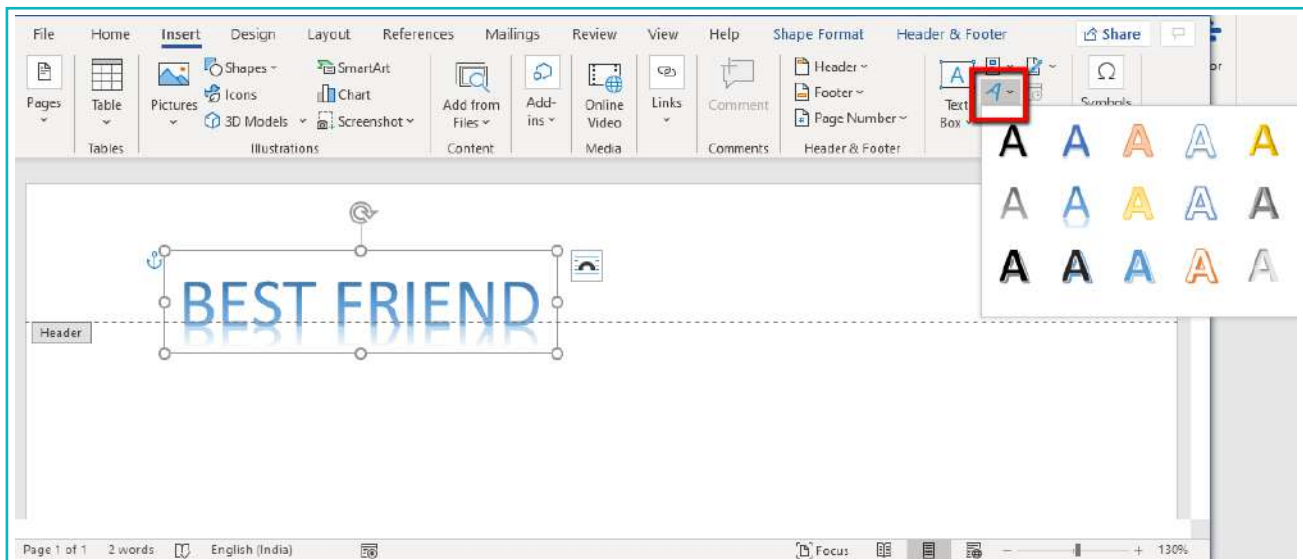
- 1 Open the MS Word software.
- 2 Add a header to the page for the comic strip heading:
  - a. Click on the **insert** menu
  - b. Select **header**



- c. Select blank header
- d. Write the heading of the story  
“BEST FRIEND”

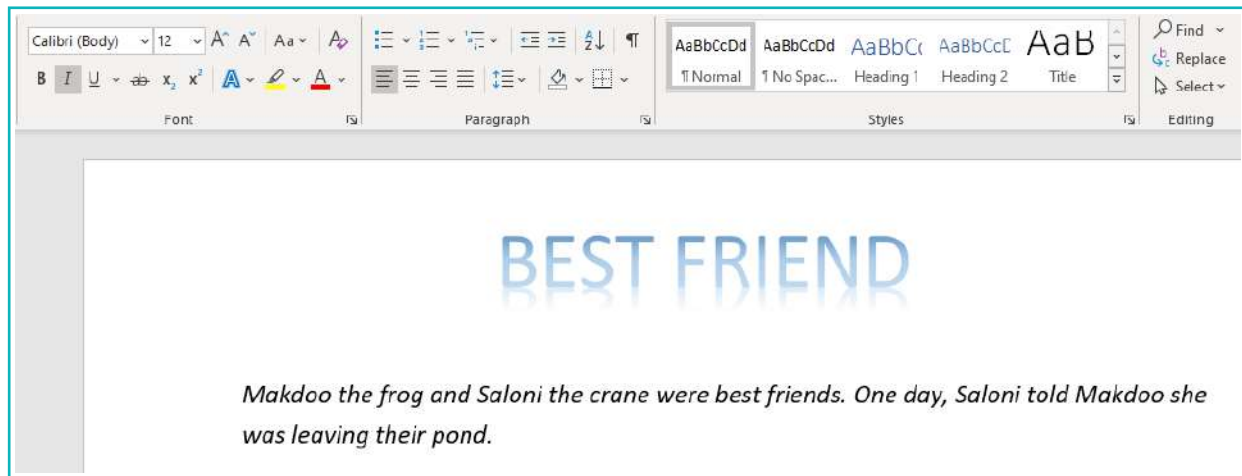


- 3 Apply a WordArt effect to the heading:
  - a. Select **WordArt** from the insert tab to highlight the heading. Choose any one effect for the heading.
  - b. Move the heading to the centre. Double click on the page to apply the header effect.





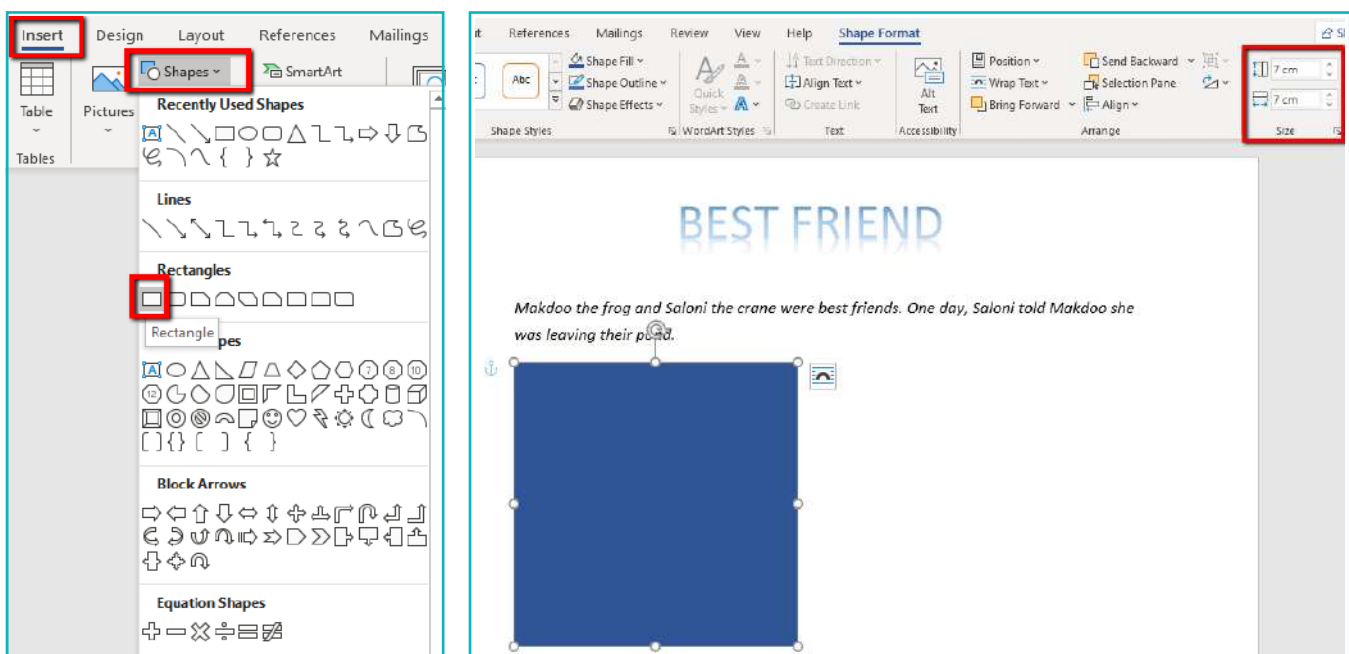
After the heading, add the introduction to the comic strip:



## 4 Create a background for the comic strip:

**Shapes:** MS Word contains basic shapes, lines, curves, arrows, and speech bubbles which are used to add visual elements to a document.

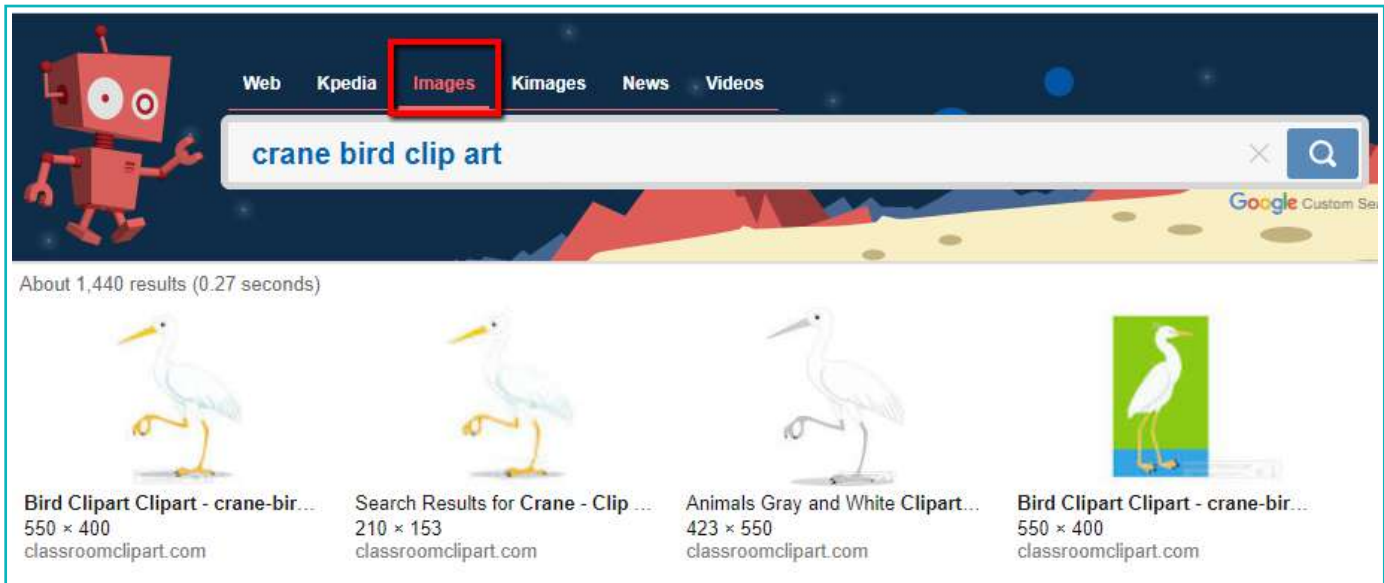
- Click on **Shapes** in the insert tab and select **rectangle** from the rectangles option.
- Drag and resize the rectangle and set its size.



- 5 Add a character in front of the background:
- a. Insert a picture of the character (Saloni the crane) for the first dialogue:  
“Saloni: Makdoo, I am leaving! I will be back in a few months.”

**Note:** For the images, go to Kiddle and download an appropriate picture of the characters for the comic strip.

**Use keywords:** crane bird clip art and frog clip art.



### Bytes

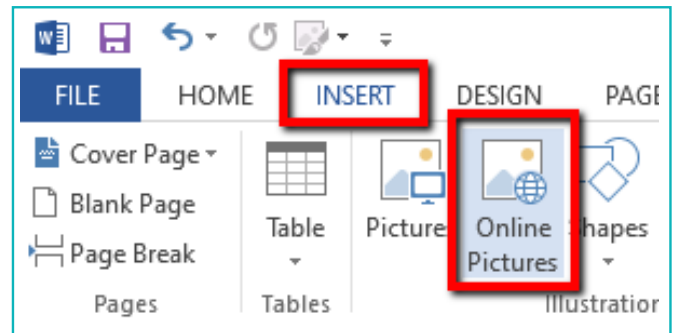
Clip Art is a simple picture or symbol available online for computer users to add to their documents.

## Healthy Practices:

- You need permissions to use most images on the internet.
- Create your own drawings or capture your own photos as far as possible.
- Use Free Images whenever possible since they do not have an owner and do not need to be paid for.

a. Use MS Word to find free images:

- Go to **INSERT** and click on **Online Pictures**.



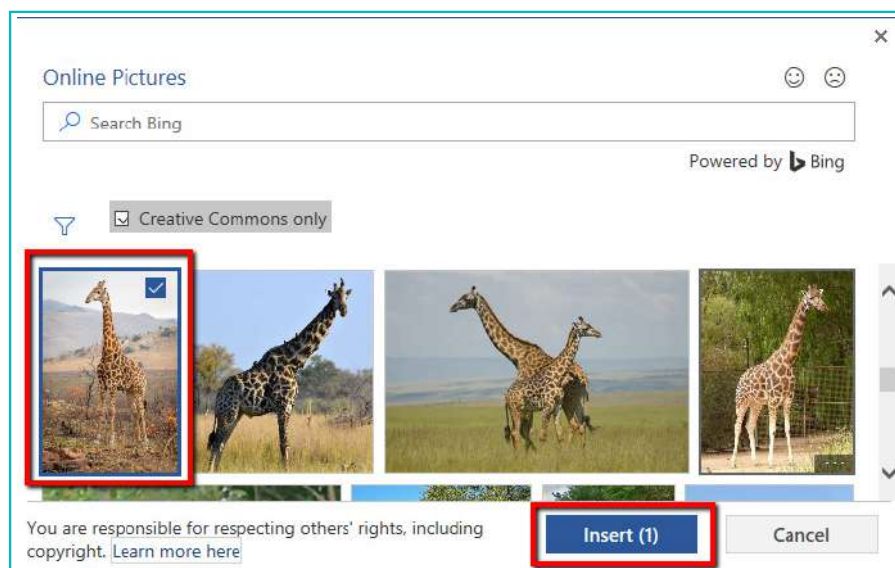
- In the search option, type a keyword for the image you want (For example: Giraffe).



- The **Creative Commons only** option should always be selected.

Creative Commons: A gallery of license free images that are free to use.

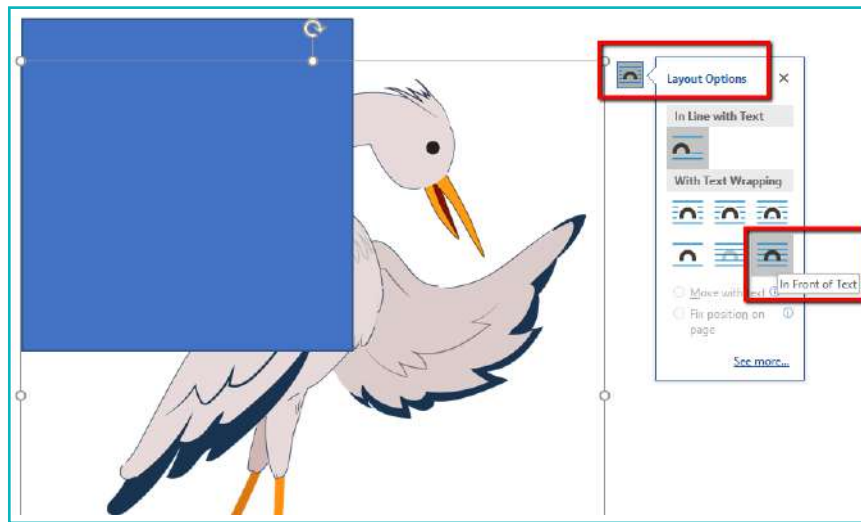
a. Select any image and click Insert (1)



- b. Download and save the pictures on your desktop.
- c. To insert the image from the desktop to the document, use the **Pictures** option.
- d. To align the picture with the background, select the picture and click on the **Layout** option:

The '**In Front of Text**' option allows us to place images in front of a background. It does not affect the background at all.

- e. Select **in front of text** from the **Wrap Text** option.



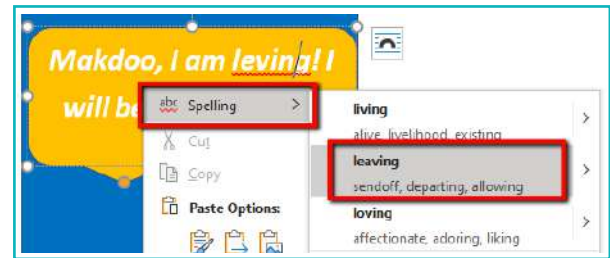
- f. Add the dialogue behind the image. To display the dialogue, we use speech bubbles.

- 6 Select the **Callout** option from Shapes:
  - a. Click on a **speech bubble** and drag it inside the background.
  - b. Write the first dialogue in the speech bubble.
  - c. Format the dialogue text (font size, style, colour, etc).



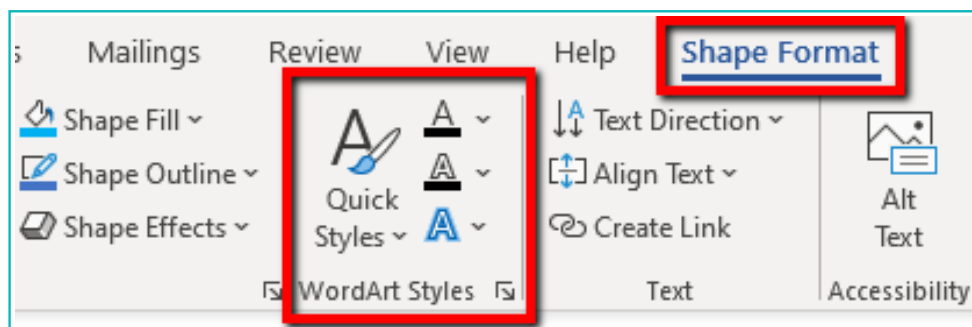
7 We can use **spell check** to check and spellings of words in MS Word.

- A red line under a word indicates that the spelling is wrong.
- Right click on the word and choose the correct spelling. We can also check its meaning.



8 We can use **shape fill** to add colours to the background:

- Double click on the background and select **shape fill** to choose a colour.



### Bytes

Double click on the speech bubble to apply Text Effects such as shadows and reflection to the dialogue.

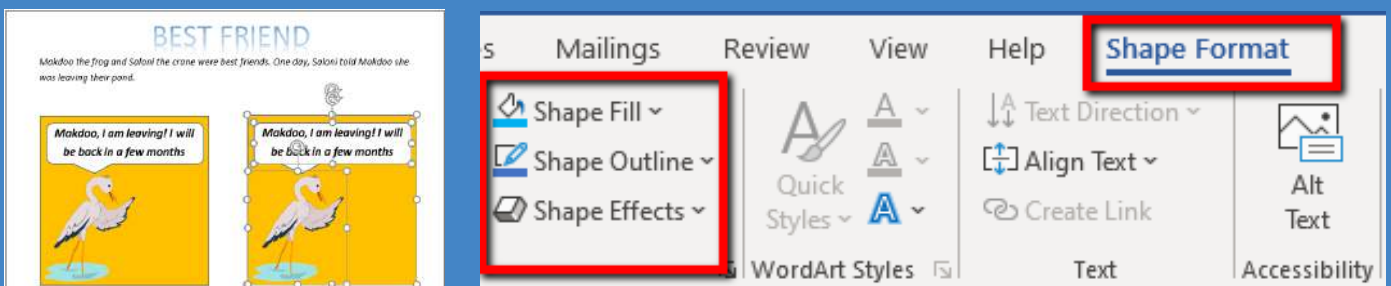
### Exercise

 **Tick Mark** ☒ the correct answer

- 1 What is a header and footer?
  - a. Top and bottom margin respectively ☐
  - b. Bottom and top margin respectively ☐
  - c. Top and middle margin respectively ☐
- 2 Which option lets us select a rectangle shape from the layout option?
  - a. Pictures ☐
  - b. WordArt ☐
  - c. Shapes ☐
- 3 Which option in shapes allows us to add speech bubbles for dialogues?
  - a. Rectangles ☐
  - b. Basic shapes ☐
  - c. Callouts ☐

### Bytes

We use Shape Format to apply effects like borders to shapes.





9 Create the other panels of the comic strip:

Let us use this shortcut!

- Select any one element of the comic, for example: the background.
- Press and hold the **shift key** and select the other elements.
- Use the shortcut for copy (Ctrl+C) and paste (Ctrl+V) it on the same page.
- Delete the old character and add the new character into the second panel as shown.
- Apply **in front of text** to display the dialogue with the character.



- Change the dialogue in the second strip to: “**Makdoo: Where are you going Saloni? Why don’t you stay here with me?**”
- Select the speech bubble and rotate the object to match the character’s direction.

**Note:** We use rotate to move the speech bubble arrow towards the character. It will look like character is speaking.

- Change the colour of the speech bubble and text of the second dialogue.



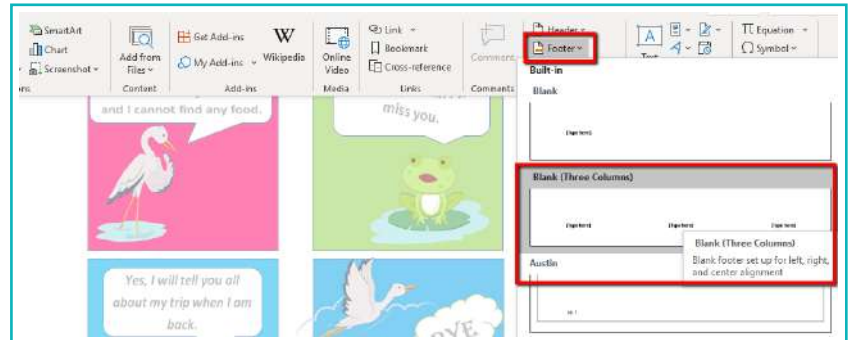


Repeat the same process and complete the rest of the panels.



10 Add a footer to the comic strip to write your name and the date:

- Click on the **insert** tab.
- Select **footer**.



- Add your name and the date inside the footer to highlight it.
- Double click on the page to apply the effect.



Final Page design of the comic strip:



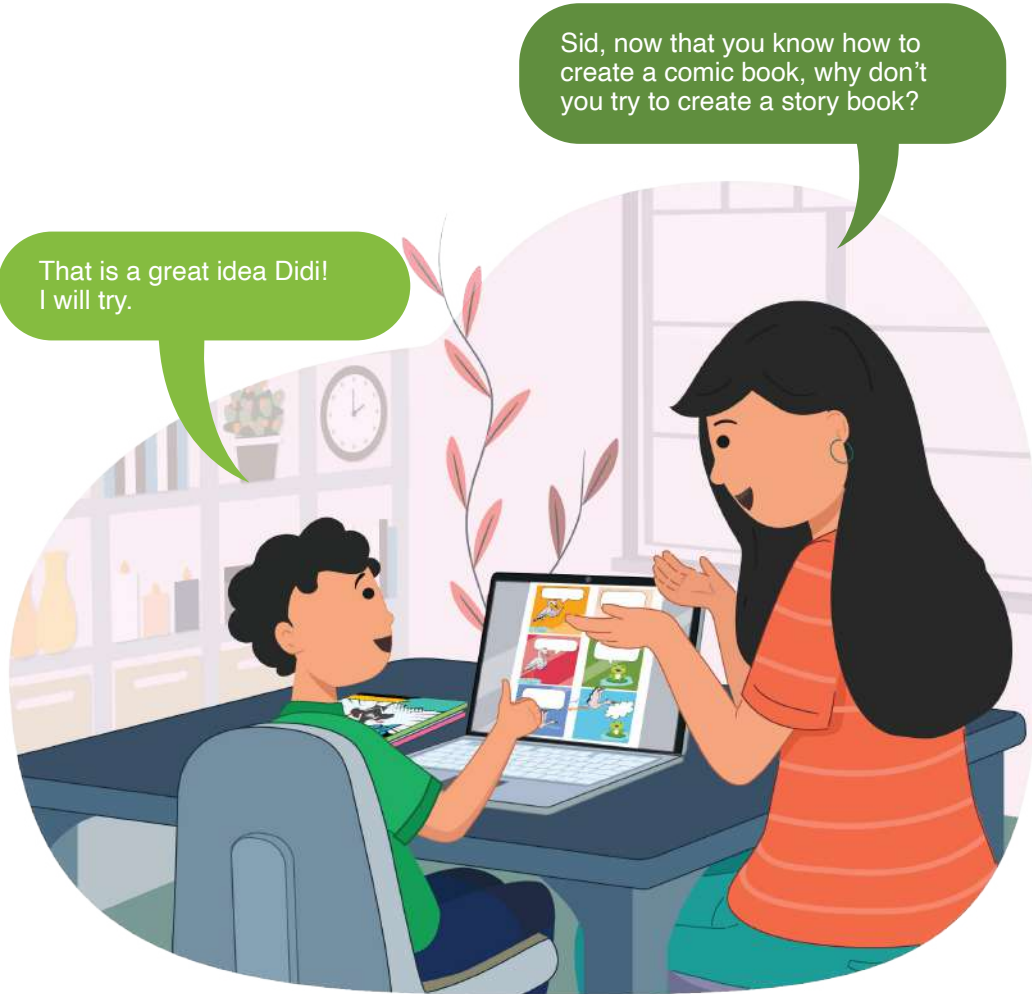
Today, we learnt about comic books and how to use the Insert tab to create our own comic strip in MS Word. Similarly, we can use visual effects to create any page in or a cover for a document.

### Exercise

#### Fill in the blanks

- 4 \_\_\_\_\_ is used to apply borders to shapes.
- 5 \_\_\_\_\_ option is used to align a picture with text.
- 6 Change the colour of a speech bubble and rectangle with shape \_\_\_\_\_.





### Tech Flash

- Header** : Header is the top margin of the page.
- Footer** : Footer is the bottom margin of the page.
- Shapes** : Shapes is an option to select prebuilt basic shapes, lines, arrows, speech bubbles and more, which are used to add visual impact to the document.
- Shape Format** : It allows us to apply effects to selected objects and shapes like shape outline, shape fill, rotation, shape effects and more.